

`manifest.json`

It is the most important file in a Chrome Extension.

Think:

`manifest.json`



Extension configuration file



Tells Chrome:

Who am I?
What permissions do I need?
Which files should run?
Which websites can I access?

◆ `manifest_version`

`"manifest_version": 3`

`manifest_version`

→ predefined Chrome Extension property

`3`

→ Manifest V3 format

Think:

Chrome:
Which extension format are you using?

Extension:
Version 3

◆ `name`

`"name": "Auto Spam Detector"`

`name`

→ predefined property

Value:

Auto Spam Detector

This is what Chrome displays.

Example:

Extensions

↓

Auto Spam Detector

◆ **version** 

"version": "1.0"

version

→ predefined property

Used by Chrome to track extension versions.

Example:

**1.0
1.1
2.0**

◆ **permissions**

"permissions": ["activeTab"] 

permissions

→ predefined property

Chrome asks:

What powers do you need?

Here:

activeTab

means:

**Allow extension to work
with currently active tab**

Example:

If Gmail tab is open:

activeTab

allows interaction with that tab.

◆ **host_permissions**

```
"host_permissions": [
  "http://3.110.181.26:8080/*"  "http://localhost:8080/*"
]
```

Very important.

Chrome extensions cannot call random servers.

Without permission:

```
fetch("http://3.110.181.26:8080")
```

↓

Blocked 

So you tell Chrome:

```
I want permission
to communicate with:
http://3.110.181.26:8080/*
```

Meaning:

```
http://3.110.181.26:8080/email/analyze
```

Allowed 

```
http://3.110.181.26:8080/anything
```

Allowed 

What does:

```
*
```

mean?

Wildcard.

Think:

Everything after /

Example:

```
http://3.110.181.26:8080/test
http://3.110.181.26:8080/email/analyze
http://3.110.181.26:8080/abc
```

All allowed.

◆ content_scripts

"content_scripts": [

content_scripts

→ predefined property

Think:

```
"content_scripts": [
  {
    "matches": ["https://mail.google.com/*"],
    "js": ["content.js"],
    "run_at": "document_idle"
  }
]
```

Which JavaScript files
should Chrome inject
into webpages?

Your extension answers:

content.js

◆ matches

"matches": ["https://mail.google.com/*"]

Very important.

Means:

Only run on Gmail

Example:

Gmail:

https://mail.google.com/

Matches 

YouTube:

```
https://youtube.com
```

Matches ❌

Facebook:

```
https://facebook.com
```

Matches ❌

So your extension runs only on Gmail.

◆ js

```
"js": ["content.js"]
```

Means:

```
Inject content.js  
into matching pages
```

When Gmail opens:

Chrome automatically loads:

```
content.js
```

Your code starts running.

So:

```
console.log("GLOBAL Spam Detector Running");
```

runs because:

```
manifest.json  
↓  
content_scripts  
↓  
content.js  
↓  
execute
```

◆ run_at

```
"run_at": "document_idle"
```



```
run_at
```

→ predefined property

Controls:

```
When should content.js run?
```

Value:

```
document_idle
```

means:

```
Wait until page  
has mostly finished loading
```

Then execute:

```
content.js
```

Why?

Because your code uses:

```
document.querySelector(".a3s.aiL")
```

to find Gmail email content.

If script runs too early:

```
Email HTML  
not loaded yet
```

Then:

```
querySelector()
```

finds nothing.

So:

```
document_idle
```

means:

```
Run after webpage is ready
```

◆ COMPLETE FLOW

```
Chrome starts
↓
Reads manifest.json
↓
Sees matches:
https://mail.google.com/*
↓
User opens Gmail
↓
Chrome injects content.js
↓
document_idle reached
↓
content.js runs
↓
Extract email text
↓
fetch()
↓
Spring Boot
↓
Flask ML
↓
Prediction
↓
Create spam-box
↓
document.body.appendChild(box)
↓
Spam: SPAM
```

This manifest file is basically the "instruction sheet" that tells Chrome how your extension should behave. 